PHASE 1: IDEATION PHASE

Empathize & Discover – Empathy Map Canvas

Field	Details
Date	21 October 2026
Team ID	Individual Project
Project Name	StaffSync – Modern Human Resource Management System
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Empathy Map Canvas

Purpose: Understand the needs, frustrations, and behaviors of the main users of StaffSync: HR personnel, managers, and employees. The map below represents likely user needs inferred from the project scope; these assumptions should be validated with actual users if user research is conducted.

Primary User Persona 1: Employee

Empathy Dimension	Likely user perspective
Says	"I want to check my attendance and leave status without repeatedly contacting HR."
Thinks	"I need to know whether my leave request was approved and where to find company updates."
Does	Logs in, checks profile and announcements, marks attendance, applies for leave, and views training opportunities.
Feels	May feel frustrated when records or request status are difficult to find; values clarity and timely updates.
Pains	Manual follow-ups, unclear leave status, scattered announcements, and difficulty accessing personal HR information.
Gains	A simple dashboard, accurate attendance history, transparent leave tracking, and convenient access to announcements and training.

Primary User Persona 2: Manager

Empathy Dimension	Likely user perspective
Says	"I need a clear view of my team's attendance and pending leave requests."
Thinks	"I should be able to review requests and team information without handling everything manually."
Does	Reviews team attendance, approves or rejects leave requests within their authority, manages training, and records performance evaluations.
Feels	May feel overloaded when team information is spread across different systems.
Pains	Time-consuming tracking, incomplete visibility, and difficulty following up on pending requests.
Gains	A team dashboard, accessible records, clear request statuses, and faster routine decisions.

Primary User Persona 3: HR Administrator

Empathy Dimension	Likely user perspective
Says	"I need a reliable place to manage employee records and monitor key HR activities."
Thinks	"Information should be consistent, protected, and easy to retrieve when needed."
Does	Manages employee and manager records, oversees attendance and leave, publishes announcements, and reviews HR summaries.
Feels	May feel concerned when data is inconsistent or routine processes require repeated manual work.
Pains	Duplicate or outdated records, limited reporting, manual coordination, and risk of unauthorized access.
Gains	Centralized records, role-based permissions, searchable lists, and useful attendance and leave summaries.

Shared Needs and Opportunities

Observed / Inferred Need	StaffSync Opportunity
One reliable source of HR information	Centralize employee profiles and related HR records in

	the application.
Clear status and feedback	Display attendance state and leave-request status clearly.
Appropriate access to information	Apply role-based access for employees, managers, and HR.
Easy navigation	Provide role-specific dashboards, search, filters, and pagination where appropriate.
Timely company communication	Make announcements and relevant in-app notifications accessible.
Convenient development opportunities	List training programs and support enrollment workflows.

Key Design Considerations

- Keep the most common tasks easy to find from each role's dashboard.
- Show clear confirmation and error messages for actions such as check-in, leave submission, and approval.
- Protect personal and employment information through authentication and role-based authorization.
- Use responsive layouts so users can access essential workflows on different screen sizes.
- Validate these inferred needs through feedback or usability testing rather than treating them as confirmed research findings.

Conclusion

The empathy map identifies three main user groups for StaffSync and summarizes their likely goals, behaviors, pain points, and desired outcomes. These insights guide the design of role-specific dashboards and core HR workflows. Since this version is based on the planned project features rather than documented interviews, the assumptions should be validated with users where possible.

Reference template: Mural – Empathy Map Canvas (https://www.mural.co/templates/empathy-map-canvas)